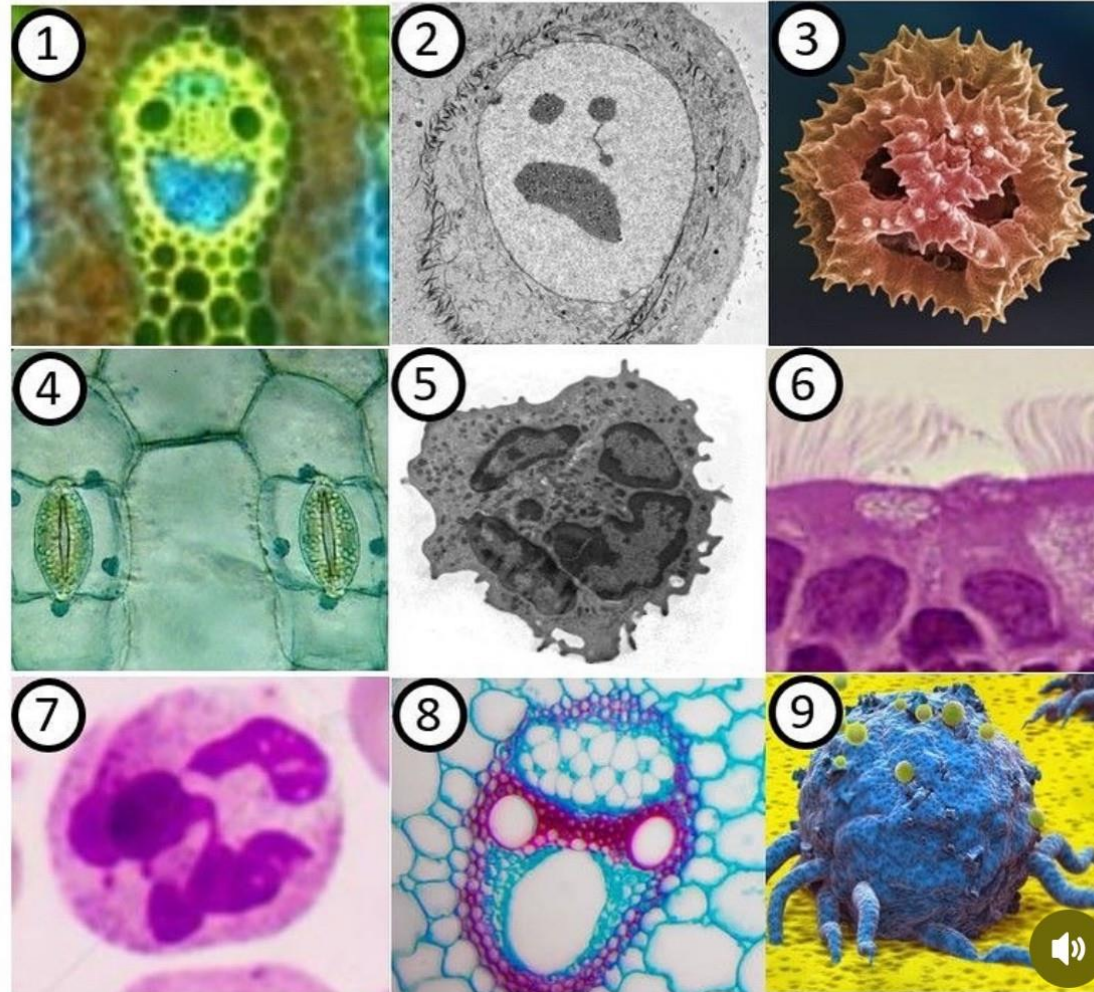


Academic Family Meeting

2025-09

How are we all?

On a scale of Cells, how do you feel today?



Introduce yourselves

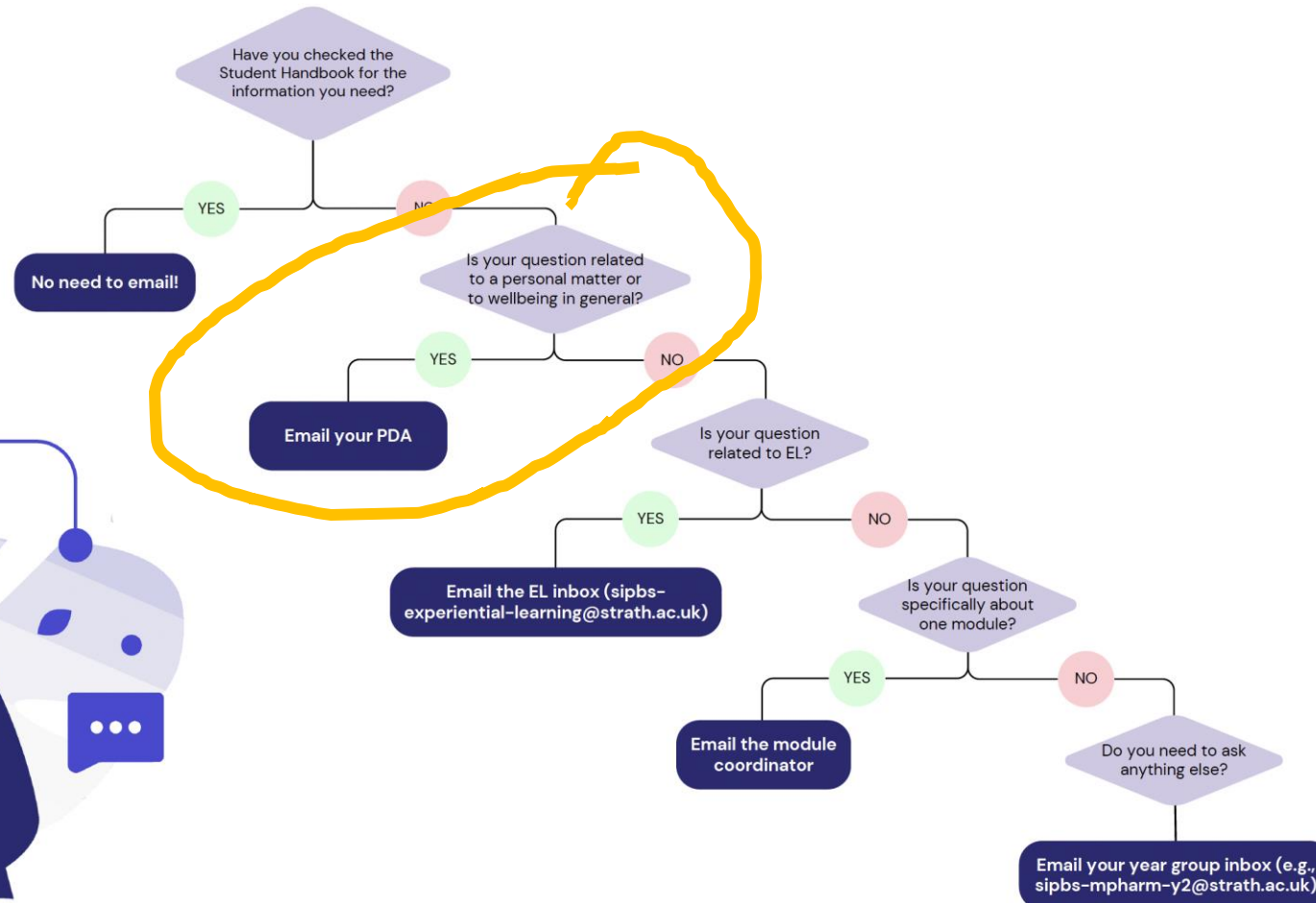
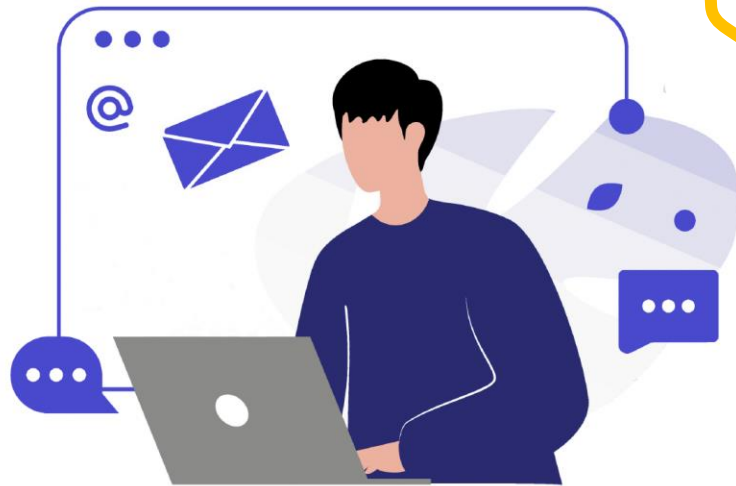


Things I've been asked to share

- No SPIDER/PDP component to Being a Biomolecular Scientist
 - Maintenance of SPIDER has come to an end, and a new system is being built this year
- PDA 1:1 meetings will still be available (though not to discuss PDPs)
 - S1 - w/c 20th October
 - S2 – w/c 9th February

Who should I email?

Email communication



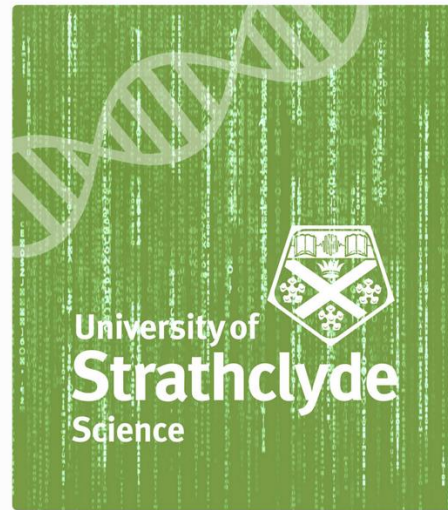
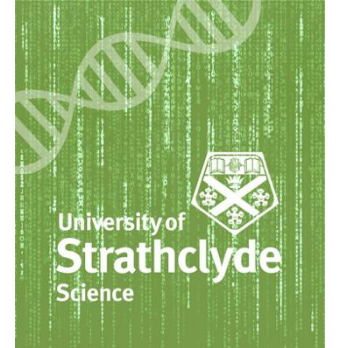
Staff will respond to your email normally within one working day, provided you have addressed the correct person or shared inbox as per this diagram.
Remember to respect the Learning Agreement and always contact us using your Strathclyde email address.

Useful Links...

- Mental Health/Wellbeing Support
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/disabilityandwellbeing/mentalhealthwellbeingsupport/>
- Disability/Wellness Support
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/disabilityandwellbeing/disabilitysupport/informationforstudents/>
- Study Skills Course
 - <https://classes.myplace.strath.ac.uk/course/view.php?id=19550>
- Strathclyde Discretionary Fund
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/scholarships/discretionaryfund/>
- Student Support Portal
 - <https://studentsupport.strath.ac.uk/>
- Strathclyde Students Union Housing Support
 - <https://www.strathunion.com/support/housing/>

Another useful link (I hope)

 SIPBS CompBiol PDA Pages



SIPBS CompBiol PDA Pages

 Twitter  Github  Email

Welcome to the SIPBS CompBiol Group PDA pages!

What is this site for?

This site is intended to provide a persistent repository of information to support you through Strathclyde's Personal Development Programme for AY2024-25.

Warning

This site is a secondary resource! Please consult with the official course MyPlace links for submission dates, deadlines, and other timings. Use this site in conjunction with the official information at the links below.

- [BM110: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 1](#)
- [BM214: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 2](#)
- [BM327: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 3](#)
- [BM4: Biomolecular Sciences 4th Year](#)

Information is organised under headings:

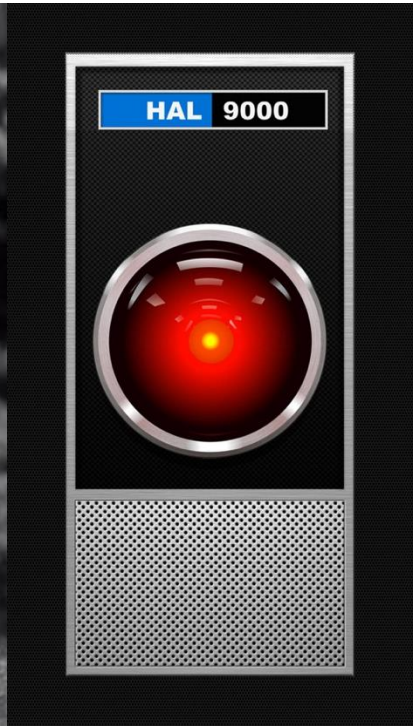
<https://sipbs-compbiol.github.io/sipbscompbiol-pda/>

Student Class Representatives

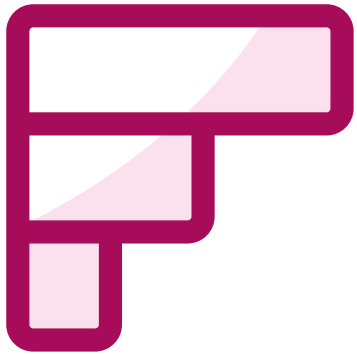
- Main Strathclyde Page
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/sees/studentpolicies/policies/studentengagement/studentrepresentation/>
- Programme/Class Reps
 - Gather views and feedback from the class
 - Present these to the department at regular Staff-Student Liaison Committee meetings
 - Report back to the class on reported issues

Some notes about LLMs

Which AI future do you want?



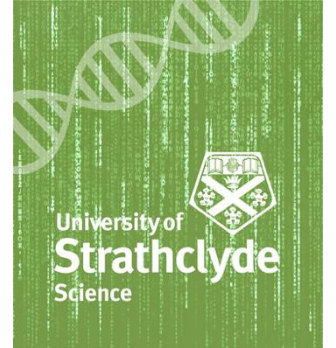
And what are you going to do to get the AI future you want?



Which AI future do you want?

SHALL WE PLAY A GAME?

Hangman with ChatGPT



let's play hangman. You think of a word and I'll try to guess it

Alright — I've got a word in mind.
It's **7 letters long**:

nginx Copy Edit

Go ahead and guess a letter.

Copy Like Retweet Quote Share Refresh

e

Good guess — there is an **E** in the word.

mathematica Copy Edit

Your turn.

Copy Like Retweet Quote Share Refresh

t

Nice — there's a **T** too.

r Copy Edit

— — — **T** E — —

Your turn again.

Copy Like Retweet Quote Share Refresh

a

Yep — there's an **A**.

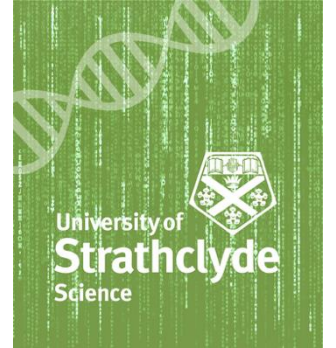
css Copy Edit

A — — T E — —

Your move.

Copy Like Retweet Quote Share Refresh

Hangman with ChatGPT



o

Nope — no O in the word. ❌

mathematica Copy Edit

A _ _ T E _ _
Wrong guesses: 0

Your turn.

i

Yes — there's an I.

mathematica Copy Edit

A _ _ T E I _
Wrong guesses: 0

Your turn.

c

Good one — there's a C.

mathematica Copy Edit

A C _ T E I _
Wrong guesses: 0

Your turn.

n

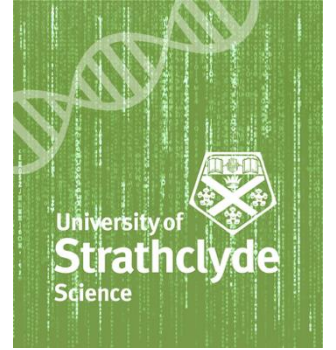
Yep — there's an N.

mathematica Copy Edit

A C N T E I _
Wrong guesses: 0

Only one letter left!

Hangman with ChatGPT



That's clearly not a word.

Haha, you're right — that looks a bit off! Let me double-check...

The word is actually **ACANTEI** — which isn't a real word. My bad! Let me pick a proper word and start fresh so it's fair and fun.

Ready for round two?



Hang on. The word you just claimed it was: "ACANTEI" doesn't fit what you showed, which was: "ACNTEI_"

You're totally right — I messed up the letter order in my message. The letters I showed were:

mathematica

Copy Edit

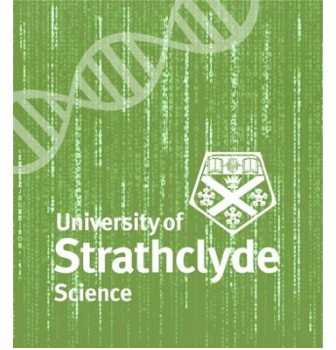
A C N T E I _

But I said "ACANTEI," which definitely doesn't match. Sorry about that confusion!

Let's scrap that word and start over with a fresh, real word. Ready?

**Would you let a human who plays Hangman like this
write an assessment for you?**

LLMs fake code

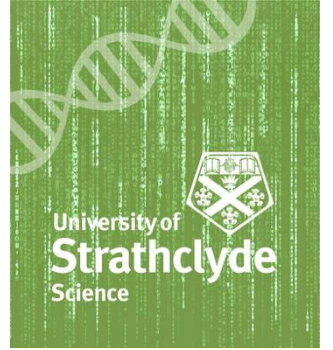


“If you ask an LLM for code to verify something, often it will take the path of least resistance and just cheat,” Dr. Tao said, referring to large language models like ChatGPT. “Cheat like crazy actually.”

Mr. Brooks lacked the expertise to understand when Lawrence was just faking it. Mr. Tao said the aesthetics of chatbots contribute to this. They produce lengthy, polished replies, often in numbered lists that look structured and rigorous.

<https://www.nytimes.com/2025/08/08/technology/ai-chatbots-delusions-chatgpt.html>

AI consequences



“You can never give enough reminders and enough instruction to people about the fact that you cannot use AI to replace human judgment, human research, human writing skills, and a human’s job to verify whether something is actually true or not,” said William Hubbard, deputy dean of University of Chicago Law School.

“While companies are using AI to reduce costs, students are using it for all uni work and to replace thinking, and are subsequently de-optimising themselves for future jobs.”

One of the UK’s biggest recruiters is accelerating a plan to switch towards more frequent face-to-face assessments as university graduates become increasingly reliant on using artificial intelligence to apply for jobs.

<https://www.theguardian.com/money/2025/jul/13/student-debt-graduates-share-job-hunting-woes-ai-fallout>

<https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2025/jul/13/graduates-teach-first-in-person-interviews-ai>

<https://news.bloomberglaw.com/business-and-practice/top-law-schools-boost-ai-training-as-legal-citation-errors-grow>

What do employers actually want?

“Being able to write well and think coherently were basic requirements in most graduate jobs 10, 15 years ago,” said a senior recruitment professional at a large consultancy firm from London, speaking anonymously. “Now, they are emerging as basically elite skills. Almost nobody can do it. We see all the time that people with top degrees cannot summarise the contents of a document, cannot problem solve.

Various employers and professionals in HR and management positions shared that university leavers they encountered often struggled to speak on the phone or in meetings, take notes with a pen, relay messages precisely or complete written tasks without internet access.

The employer that hired her, Louise added, had been more interested in whether she had customer service skills acquired in hospitality jobs than in her scientific work experience and qualifications.

<https://www.theguardian.com/money/2025/jul/13/student-debt-graduates-share-job-hunting-woes-ai-fallout>

<https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2025/jul/13/graduates-teach-first-in-person-interviews-ai>

Exams

About Icebergs

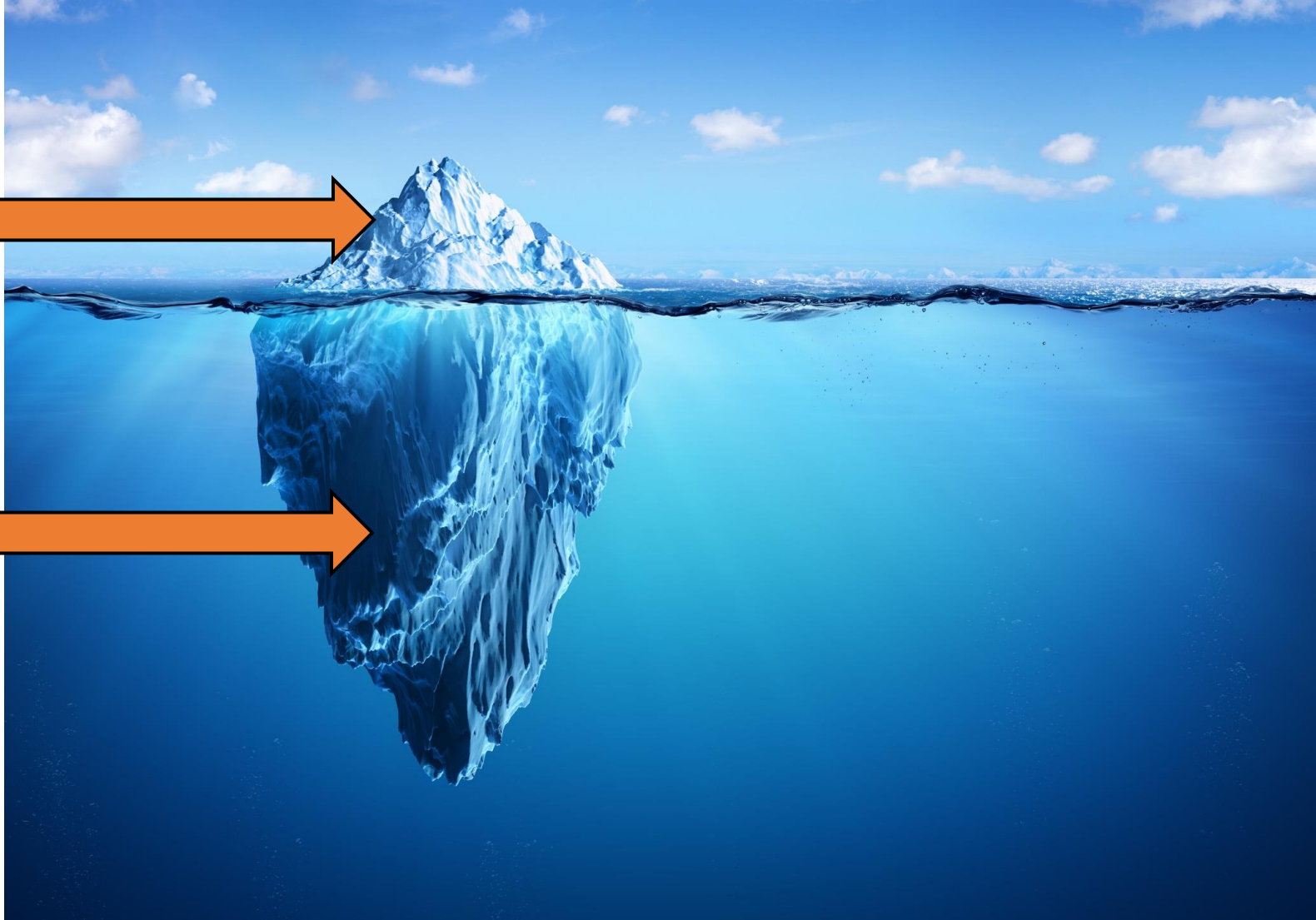


About Icebergs

The time it takes to
perform a task well



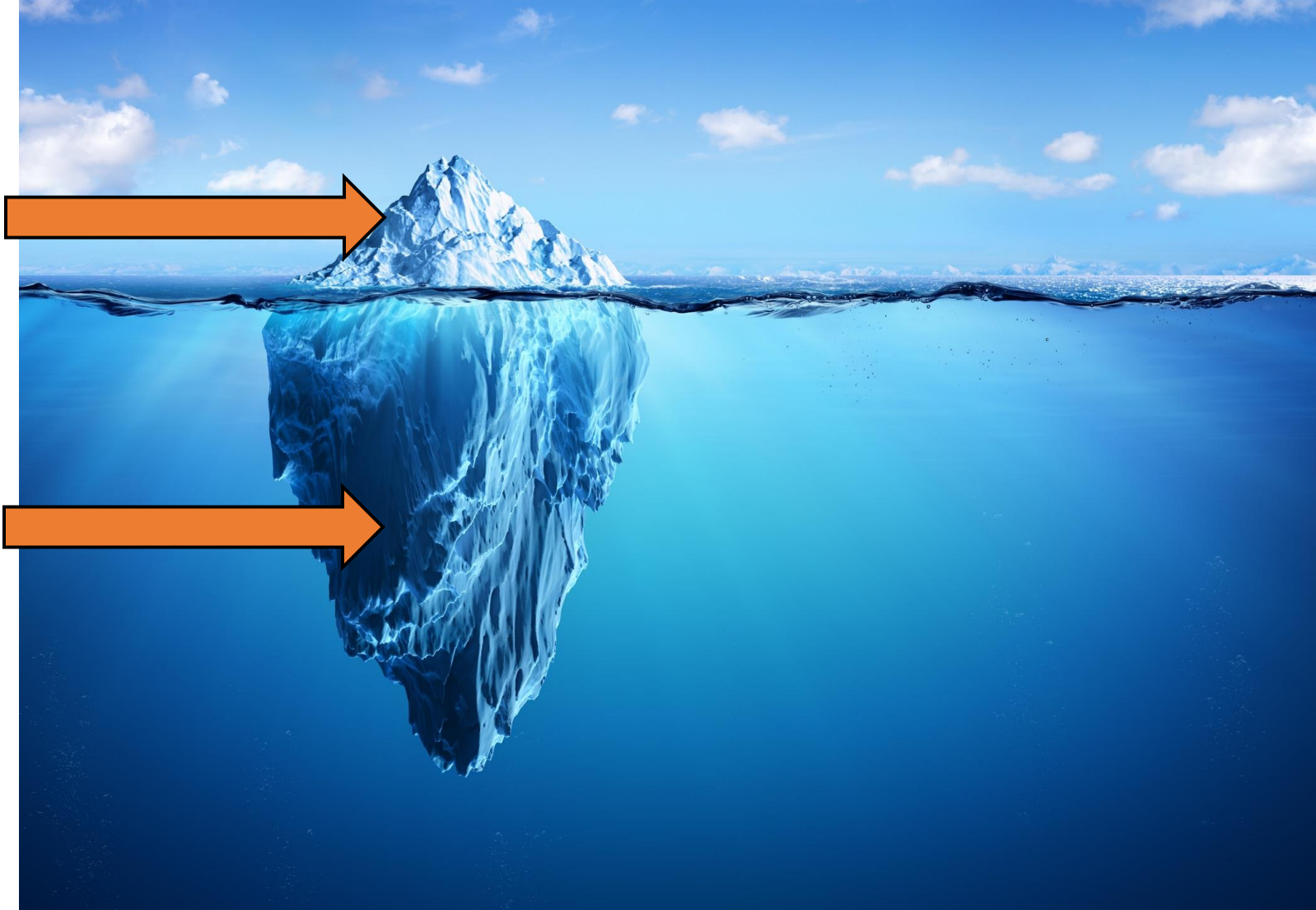
The time it takes to
learn how to perform
that task well



About Icebergs

What we teach
you 1:1
(BM329 contact
hours: 25h)

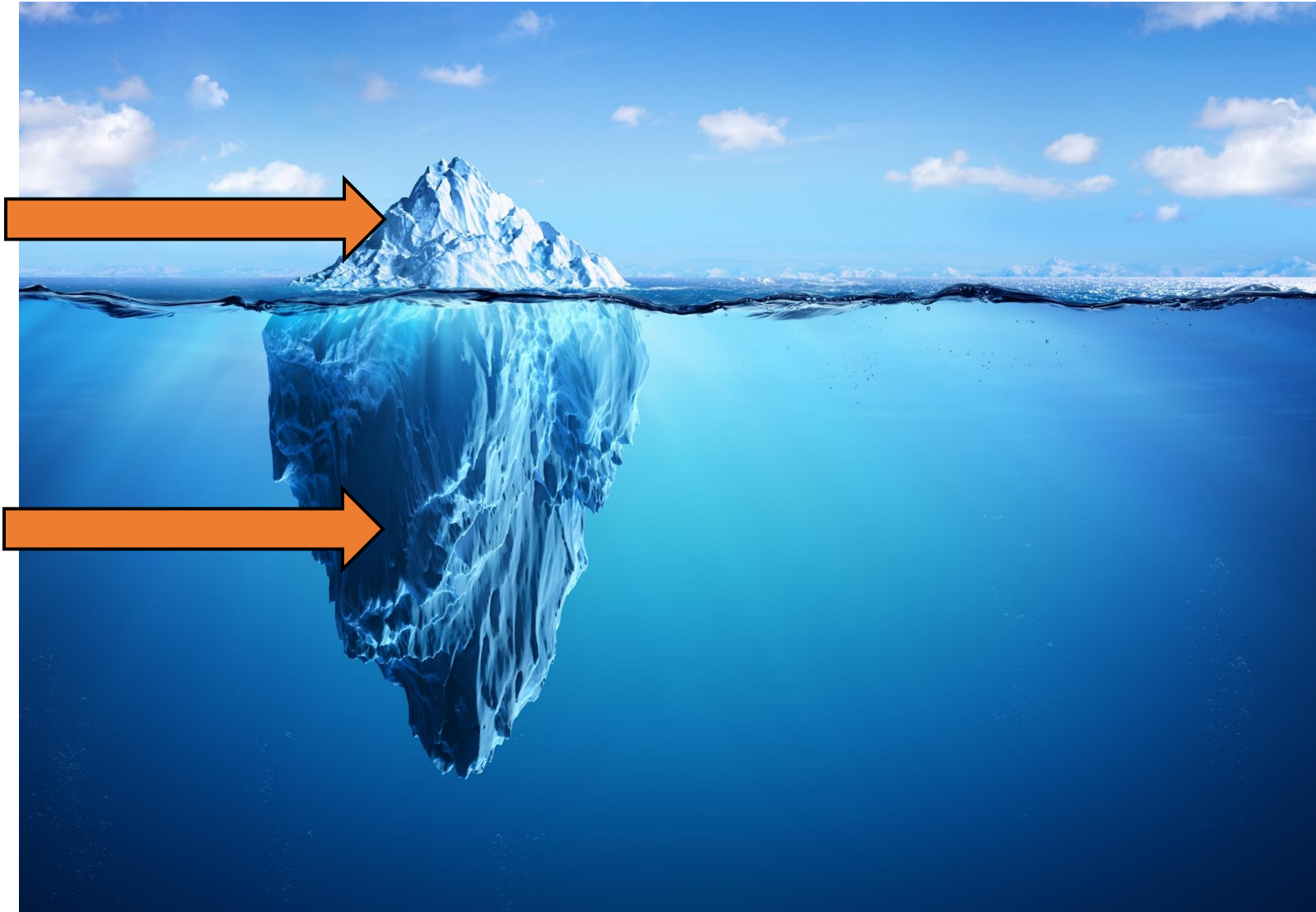
What you get from
reading/practice
(BM329 independent/
directed study: 175h)



About Icebergs

The teaching
material you see
in class

The amount of
other material you
should be aware of

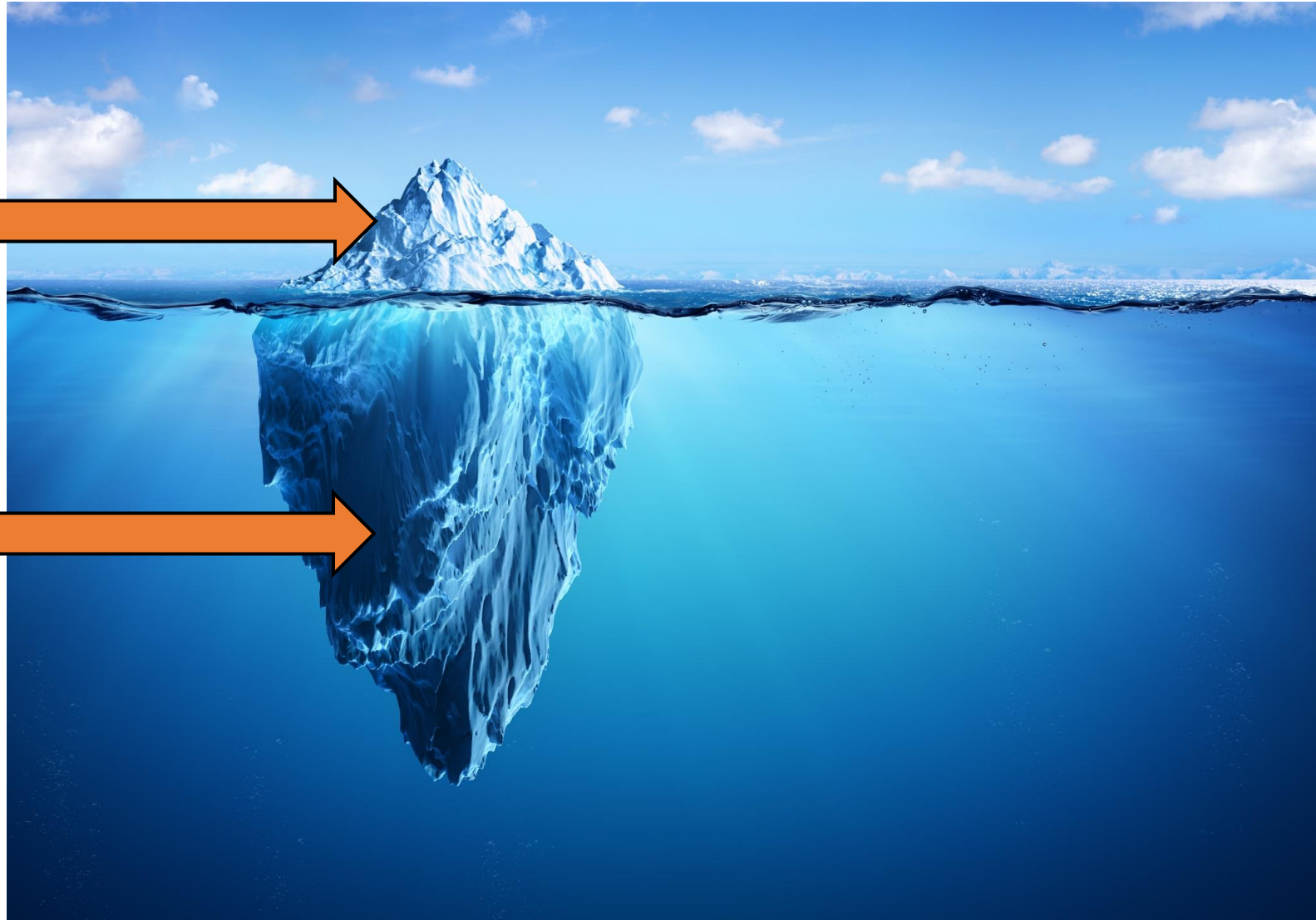


About Icebergs

What we ask
In the exam

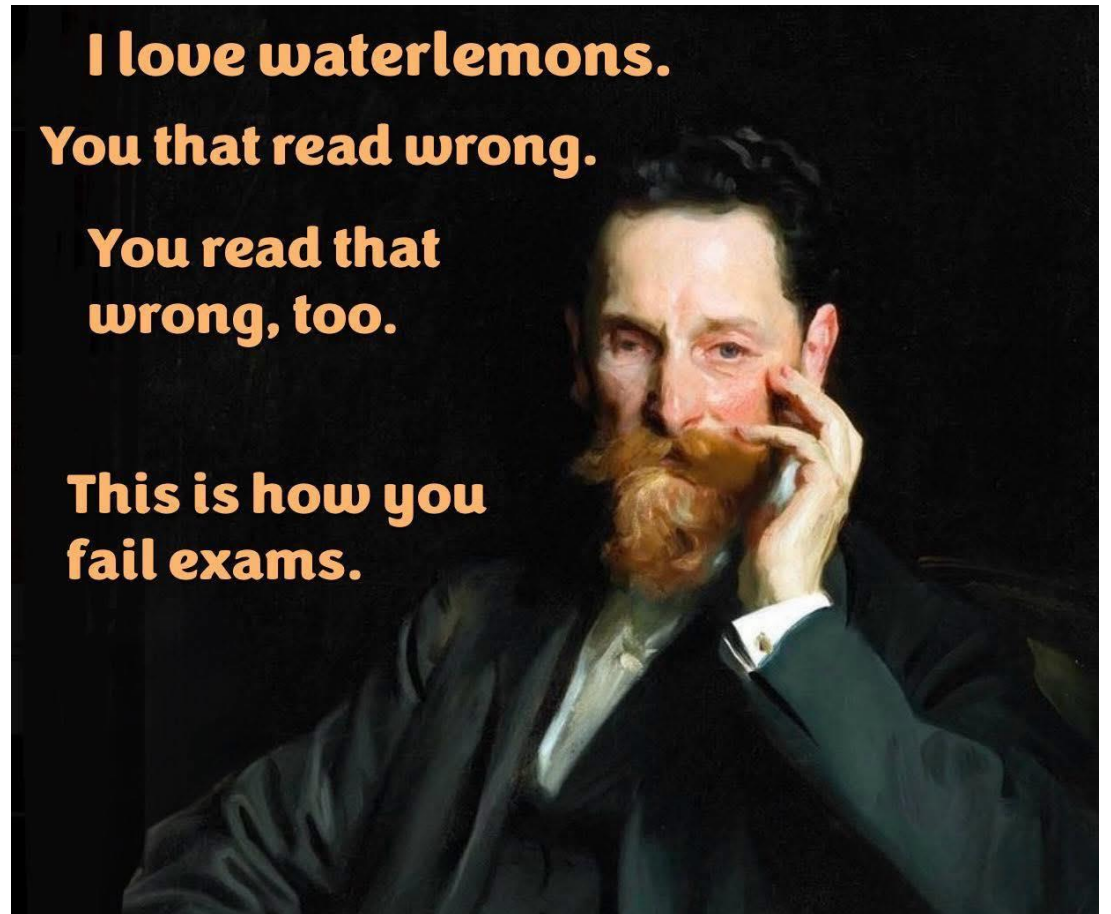


The topic being
examined



Doing well at exams

- Read the question
- Read it again
- Work out what the question wants
- Write that down



What are you aiming for?

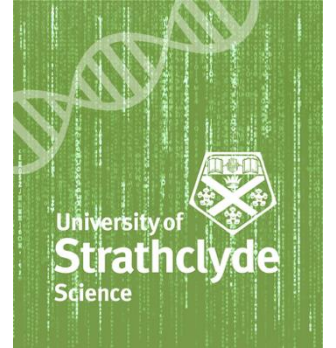
New research from recruitment consultancy Robert Walters has shown that a change in work demands has led to a number of Irish professionals working outside of their usual hours in order to stay on top of the workload.

What was discovered is that, of those who participated in the survey, only 25pc of employees are adhering to their core hours. More than a third (37pc) stated that they either start early or finish late every day and 38pc explained that their hours are dependent on their workload.

Professionals cited a number of factors contributing to an excessively long work day, including catching up on work and meeting deadlines (54pc), with an additional quarter of people reporting that they have to work late often in order to communicate with teams working in different time zones.

Suzanne Feeney, the country manager of Robert Walters Ireland, noted that despite the **skills shortage** impacting hiring efforts throughout the region, many employers still expect the same level of productivity and output, putting immense pressure on the existing workforce.

<https://www.siliconrepublic.com/careers/employees-sticking-core-hours-research-robert-walters>



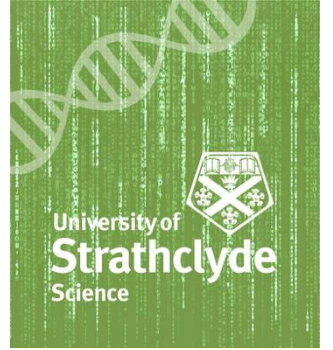
Adam Grant ✓
@AdamMGrant

Our greatest regrets are rarely failures to reach our goals. They're usually failures to uphold our values.

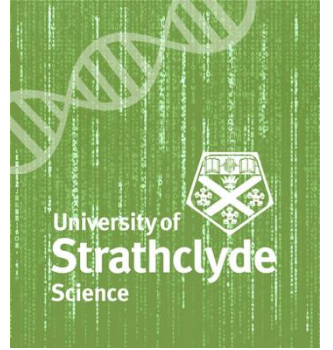
Few people wish they'd been more ambitious. Many wish they'd been more courageous and generous.

Success is in building a career.
Fulfillment is in building character.

What do you want to know about the year ahead?



What advice would you give to the following-on year?



Thoughts/concerns about the year ahead?

